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INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BOX, INDEX CARD, PLASTIC

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specifications covers plastic index card boxes, with hinged covers.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type and size. Index card boxes shall be of one type and in the following sizes:

Size I - for 3-x 5-inch cards
Size II - for 4-x 6-inch cards
Size III - for 5-x 8-inch cards

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

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FSC 7520

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The boxes shall be fabricated of polypropylene plastic and shall be nonflammable, flame resistant or slow burning when tested in accordance with 4.4, and shall show no evidence of warping or cracking when subjected to the accelerated service test in 4.3.

3.2 Design and construction. The boxes shall be designed to contain index cards without damaging them and to readily permit their removal and replacement. The construction shall be such that the boxes shall not break or crack when tested as specified in 4.5.1. The cover section of the boxes shall be integral with the base section, with the cover-hinged to the base at the back of the boxes. The cover shall easily open and remain open more than 90°

The cover shall land evenly and squarely on a ledge formed at the upper part of the base section and shall not slip over the ledge or bind when tested in accordance with 4.5.2. The cover shall overlap the base section by not less than 3/32 inch and shall stay closed until manually opened and shall stay opened in excess of 90° until manually closed when tested in accordance with 4.5.3. The boxes and hinged shall show no evidence of defects which might affect the use of the boxes, when carefully examined after testing in accordance with 4.5.3.

The interior of the boxes shall have a smooth finish and the bottom shall have projection ridges not less than 1/32 inch high and suitably located to aid in retaining the index cards in position and prevent them from sliding along the bottom and slipping down in the boxes.

The exterior top and vertical surfaces shall simulate grained leather. The bottom of the boxes shall have no sharp edges or projections which might scratch or mar a surface on which the boxes rests. The top surface may have a smooth area suitable for labeling purposes.

3.3 Dimensions. The inside dimensions, hinge length and wall thickness shall be as shown in table I.

TABLE I. Dimensions in inches

Size	Overall dimensions						Cover section		Base section		Top and base section
	Height		Width		Depth		Height		Height		Wall thickness,
	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.
I (3X5)	3-3/8	3-3/4	5-1/8	5-1/2	2-5/8	3-1/4	7/8	1-1/8	2-1/2	2-3/4	0.065
II (4X6)	4-3/8	4-3/4	6-1/4	6-5/8	3-3/4	4-3/8	7/8	1-1/8	3-1/4	3-1/2	.075
III (5X8)	5-1/8	5-1/2	8-3/8	8-3/4	3-7/8	4-1/4	1-1/2	1-3/4	3-3/4	4	.090

Hinge length

Size	Min. in.
I (3X5)	4
II (4X6)	4-3/4
III (5X8)	6-3/4

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3.4 Color. Unless otherwise specified, the color shall be gray. The box color shall be without streaks or variations.

3.5 Identification marking. Each box shall be permanently and legibly marked with the name or trademark of the manufacturer.

3.6 Workmanship. The boxes shall be free from any defects and imperfections which adversely affect the appearance or which might impair the serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Size of lot. All index card boxes presented for inspection at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of examination and test.

4.2.2 Sampling and inspection for acceptance. Sampling and inspection for acceptance shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified.

4.2.3 Examination of the end item. The examination shall be based on a acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units and shall be in accordance with the defects listed in table II. The sample unit shall be one box sampled at inspection level S-4.

TABLE II. Visual and dimensional examination

Cover not integral with the base section.
Cover does not open more than 90°.
Cover does not remain open sufficiently to preclude interference with use of cards.
Cover does not land evenly and squarely.
Cover overlaps base section by less than 3/32 inch.
Interior surfaces not smooth.
Bottom of interior does not have required ridges.
Bottom ridges not suitably located.
Bottom ridges less than 1/32 inch high.
Exterior top and vertical surfaces do not simulate grained leather.
Inside dimensions not as specified.
Material thickness less than specified in table I.
Color not as specified.
Color of box is streaked or varies.
Box does not have identification marking, as required.
Box not free from defects of workmanship.
Hinge has defects which might affect use of box.
Hinge not centered at backs of box.
Hinge length less than specified in table I.

4.2.4 Testing of the end item. Testing shall be done at inspection level S-3 on index card boxes selected from those sampled in accordance with 4.2.3 and at an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.1 and 3.2.

4.2.5 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one

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shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of container.

4.3 Accelerated service test. The boxes shall be subjected successively to each of the following conditions prior to the remaining tests and shall be examined to determine compliance with 3.1:

24 hours at 160° ± 2° F. in a chamber, with the specimen placed closed on an insulated shelf, at 70-75 percent relative humidity.
24 hours in a chamber at -40° ± 4° F., starting within 30 minutes after the first step of the exposure cycle has been completed.
24 hours at 160° ± 2° F. in a chamber, starting within 2 hours after the second step of the exposure cycle has been completed.

4.4 Flammability test. A draft shield shall be used to reduce air current effects. Hold the specimen horizontally within the shield above a Bunsen burner having a 1-inch to 1-1/4-inch blue flame just touching an edge of the box until the specimen ignites, or for a period of not over 30 seconds. Remove from the flame. If the specimen burns when in contact with the flame but will not continue to burn when removed from the flame, it is flame resistant. If the specimen continues to burn at a rate of less than 2.5 inches per minute, it is slow-burning. If the specimen bursts into flame immediately, it shall be considered as not meeting the requirements of this specification. This test shall assure compliance with 3.1.

4.5 Construction-design tests. The following tests shall be conducted to assure compliance with the requirements of 3.2:

4.5.1 Construction-strength test. Apply a 20 pound force to the inside surface of one side of the lower portion of the box in a direction perpendicular to the surface. The force shall be uniformly distributed over an area one inch square located at the top edge one inch from the back corner. The load shall be gradually applied over a period of not less than five seconds and shall be maintained at 20 pounds for a period of five minutes. The box shall be maintained in position by an opposing pressure against the inside surface directly opposite the surface to which the force is applied. The restraining pressure shall be uniformly distributed over an area one inch square located at the top edge one inch from the back corner.

4.5.2 Cover landing test. A twenty pound weight shall be gradually applied to the top of the closed box. The applied weight shall extend beyond all four sides of the cover.

4.5.3 Cover closing test. The cover shall be fully opened and closed fifty times with a normal amount of force applied which would simulate actual conditions of use.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

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5.1.1 Level A and B. Twelve size 3" x 5", six size 4" x 6", or four size 5" x 8" index card boxes of one color shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676.

5.1.2 Level C. The index card boxes shall be packaged to afford protection against deterioration, and damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use. The supplier may use his commercial practice providing it fulfills the above requirements.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Index card boxes of one color in quantities as specified (see 6.2) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproof sealed and strapped in accordance with the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Six 3" x 5", twelve 4" x 6", or nine 5" x 8" unit packages shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The index card boxes shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest rates, in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Index card boxes are intended to be used as a file box for the maintenance of index cards or forms printed on card stock.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Color, if other than gray (3.4).
(c) Size (1.2.1).
(d) Inspection responsibility, if other than as specified herein (4.1).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing required (5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Quantities of unit packages in shipping container (see 5.2.1).

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